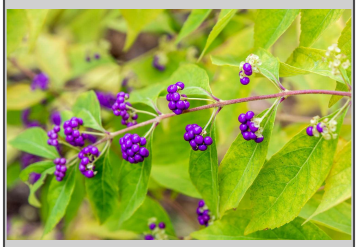
Callicarpa americana

American beautyberry, French mulberry, sourbush

Also known as: Purple beauty-berry, bunchberry | Family: Lamiaceae

Orangerie: 22 | Beltline N_S: 43 | Maintenance: 31 | **TOTAL 96**



OTHER

Not available

FALL



LEAF





FLOWER / FRUIT

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Shrub

Evergreen or deciduous
Deciduous

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 3–8 ft tall (0.9–2.4 m) and nearly as wide; can reach 9 ft in ideal conditions.
Rounded to open, arching, vase-shaped or weeping habit with age. rate

Sun

Water

Soil
Wide range of soils (sandy to clay, acid to neutral); prefers well-drained

Zone 8a
Hardy USDA zones 6–11 (or 7A–11). Native to southeastern US including Georgia. Performs well in Atlanta Zone 8a as a deciduous shrub

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Native to southeastern United States (VA to AR, south to FL & e. TX), Caribbean, northern Mexico

Form
Deciduous shrub. Opposite, elliptic to ovate leaves, light green, serrate, coarse or fuzzy texture. Inconspicuous pink, violet, or white flowers in leaf axils late spring–summer. Showy clusters of glossy purple (or white in some forms) berries encircling stems late summer–fall, persisting after leaf drop. Yellowish fall foliage. Bark light brown to reddish, with lenticels; young twigs 4-sided. Attracts birds, bees, butterflies. Berries ornamental (not for eating). Yellow-green fall color contrasts with purple fruit. Native plant

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Low maintenance. Space 4–6 ft. Prune lightly if needed.
Propagate by seed or cuttings.
Good for understory, rain gardens, wildlife

HEALTH

Health

No serious problems stated. Relatively pest-free.
Drought tolerant

Symptoms

None stated